the Constitution, whether or not it contains factual representations and even if it includes inaccurate assertions of fact. Indeed, disregard of the "truth" may be employed to give force to the underlying idea expressed by the speaker.[6] "Under the First Amendment there is no such thing as a false idea," and the only way that ideas can be suppressed is through "the competition of other ideas," *Gertz* v. *Robert Welch, Inc.*, 418 U. S., at 339–340.

Commercial price and product advertising differs markedly from ideological expression because it is confined to the promotion of specific goods or services.[7] The First Amendment protects the advertisement because of the "information of potential interest and value" conveyed, *Bigelow* v. *Virginia*, 421 U. S. 809, 822, rather than because of any direct contribution to the interchange of ideas. See *ante*, at 762–765, 770.[8] Since the factual claims contained in commercial price or product advertisements relate to tangible goods or services, they may be tested empirically and corrected to reflect the truth without in any manner jeopardizing the free dis-

---

[6] As the Court observed in *Cantwell* v. *Connecticut*, 310 U. S. 296, 310:

"To persuade others to his own point of view, the pleader, as we know, at times, resorts to exaggeration, to vilification of men who have been, or are, prominent in church or state, and even to false statement. But the people of this nation have ordained in the light of history, that, in spite of the probability of excesses and abuses, these liberties are, in the long view, essential to enlightened opinion and right conduct on the part of the citizens of a democracy."

[7] See Developments in the Law—Deceptive Advertising, 80 Harv. L. Rev. 1005, 1030–1031 (1967).

[8] The information about price and product conveyed by commercial advertisements may, of course, stimulate thought and debate about political questions. The drug price information at issue in the present case might well have an impact, for instance, on a person's views concerning price control issues, government subsidy proposals, or special health care, consumer protection, or tax legislation.